

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

you? So many of our material desires are fleeting, and easily forgotten about, even when they feel like the most important thing in the world while we are lusting after them. Sometimes, wanting something doesn't mean that we actually have to buy it – sometimes it can be a lovely, fleeting appreciation for something. Almost all of those feelings of wanting to possess something, no matter how strong they were in the moment, will pass. Like a school-age crush in both intensity and brevity, you can allow the desire for 'stuff' to wash over you, and only *buy* things when they offer you something more substantial in return for your money. Only buy things that are 'marriage material', as it were; things that you don't mind living in your house for years to come.

The second method I've found to be invaluable when it comes to wanting things is keeping a running list of things that I'd like to buy. Putting something on a list helps us to feel like we've acted on our desire for a particular item, without us actually having to make the financial commitment of buying it. It also gives us time to consider the cost, why we want it, and what the impact on our financial health will be if we do buy it. Simply writing it down rather than adding to cart is an act of rebellion against a consumer culture that wants to rush us through the checkout process before we have time to think – and it's a major step towards mindful spending.